

7.6 URBAN ECOLOGY

Objectives

- (a) To protect and enhance the natural habitat for a range of species as part of the heritage values of the site.
- (b) To encourage the creation of a cool micro-climate on the site.
- (c) To provide a resilient and biodiverse outdoor space.
- (d) To maintain and enhance the biodiversity corridor connectivity from Waverley Park to Queens Park.
- (e) To contribute to key environmental targets in Council's strategic plans.

Controls

- (a) Canopy coverage is to be provided at a minimum of 30% of the site area. This is to be demonstrated on the Landscape Plan and inclusive of landscape on slab.
- (b) Canopy coverage is to provide an appropriate cover that respects the heritage values of the place while providing a recognised habitat corridor through the site. Details of how the canopy, particularly the habitat corridor, will be maintained and managed over time is to be provided (via a Canopy Succession Plan).
- (c) Preserve and maintain the existing mature trees on the site. Where a tree cannot be maintained due to the location of a new building, this tree is to be relocated or replaced with a comparable size and species in a more suitable location on the site to support the habitat corridor.
- (d) Protection of trees on site that are to be retained is to be conducted in accordance with the provisions in Part B3.4 Protecting Trees on Development Sites in the WDCP.
- (e) Buildings are to be located to support the Habitat Corridor which runs through the site. The Habitat Corridor is to be clearly marked on the Landscape Plan with details of the proposed species and the arrangement and structure of the habitat.
- (f) In addition to the Habitat Corridor through the site, habitat species are to be planted along the periphery of the site, in the setbacks from the street frontage. This habitat is also to be clearly marked on the Landscape Plan.
- (g) At-grade car parking and roads are to be minimised within the habitat corridor to encourage a safe environment for fauna within the limitations of the site and heritage values.
- (h) A diversity of plant species is to be provided across the site.
- (i) Landscaping is to be designed and completed in a way that provides adequate fauna habitat, i.e. taking vertical space into consideration as well as horizontal space, and providing several layers of plantings. It is expected that a shrub layer 0.5 to 2.0 m will be included in at least some sections of the habitat corridor, and that some shrubs and grasses are planted in thickets to provide safe habitat for smaller fauna species. In addition, new trees are to be provided at 200L to provide for increased habitat to the periphery of the site.
- (j) Refer to the species outlined in Table 1 that are encouraged or discouraged for this site. The planting palette should include a range of species. Additional or alternate species to this list can be discussed with Council's Urban Ecology